

Methods - The second part of the Academic Paper

Purpose of the Method, Process, or Approach section:

- Explains and proves justifications for the chosen method, process, or approach.

The 3 row of the rubric addresses the Method:

1 Report on Existing Knowledge	2 Report on Existing Knowledge with Simplistic Use of a Research Method	3 Ineffectual Argument for a New Understanding	4 Well-Supported, Articulate Argument Conveying a New Understanding	5 Rich Analysis of a New Understanding Addressing a Gap in the Research Base
Describes a search and report process.	Describes an oversimplified or nonreplicable research method, with questionable alignment to the purpose of the inquiry.	Describes a replicable research method, with questionable alignment to the purpose of the inquiry.	Logically defends the alignment of a detailed, replicable research method to the purpose of the inquiry.	Logically defends the alignment of a detailed, replicable research method to the purpose of the inquiry.

To prepare for writing your own Method section. Read the sample papers attached. Consider how each executes the methods section. Pay particular attention to data collection and analysis. Pick 2 of the papers and respond to the questions.

1. What are some of the different ways to collect and analyze data you learned from reading the samples? Did any stand out to you as particularly effective or ineffective? There are two different research samples that utilize vastly different methods to collect and analyze their data. The first, published in 2017 and entitled “The Danceability of K-Pop Songs,” collected data by utilizing an analytics API to obtain exact numbers regarding the danceability, loudness, and energy of 169 different K-Pop songs. The data was analyzed by creating scatter plot charts to determine if there was a correlation between the danceability of the songs and the number of music show awards they earned.

The second sample, published in 2023 and entitled “An AAPI Curriculum for Digital Studies: An Alternative to AsianCrit?” used a qualitative method to create a school curriculum on the same topic as other existing curricula. The data were collected by analyzing existing educational frameworks to determine which aspects of the framework would be included in the new curriculum, and the data were analyzed through the creation of a custom coding system for the framework to determine which elements were directly addressed, indirectly addressed, or removed entirely from the new project.

2. Do the samples score a low, medium, or high? Why? (Try not to look at the answers at the end of the documents)

For both of these research samples, I believe the samples score in the high range (like a 5 on a scale of 1-5).

The 2017 research study scores in the high range for its methodology due to the explicit explanation of the variables used to select the songs to analyze, as well as its explanation of the variables it used to exclude from its study.

The 2023 research study scores in the high range due to the explanation of its method for creating the new AAPI digital studies curriculum, as well as its justification of the four-step process for completing the project.

3. What method will you choose for your own research? What is your justification?

I will utilize the qualitative research method for my own study on how the algorithm acts as a gatekeeper to new creators on the platform. I plan to survey and interview these new creators to determine how they feel about the algorithm, the “algorithmic gossip” they hear about it, and how their art must change according to the algorithm. While the quantitative method of analyzing the platform’s API could reveal interesting information regarding which videos earn the most views, it will not help to determine the reasons that these new creators change their art and their identities in response to the algorithm. Thus, utilizing a qualitative survey of these creators will provide the most helpful information for my research project.

4. What will you include in your own Method section?

I will include a section in my Method that explains my selection of participants (how I will find and survey these new creators), the steps that I will take to collect the data (which survey software and questions will be used), and ethical considerations regarding the research study (how I will obtain informed consent for their participation in my study, and how their channel names will remain anonymous in my research). Furthermore, I will include a data analysis strategy explaining how I will analyze the results of the surveys, such as utilizing thematic coding methods to categorize their answers, as used in the 2023 research study.